



YOU ARE **5 WEEKS AND 6 DAYS**

239 days to go...

YOUR BABY TODAY

Development in the upper body usually precedes that in the lower body—this image shows the bulge containing the heart and liver, and the very earliest sign of development of the upper limb buds, but as yet there is no sign of the lower limb buds.

“You may notice a marked increase in your breast size, even at this early stage of pregnancy.”

The first part of your body to change shape is likely to be your chest. Your breasts may increase in size quite rapidly, looking bigger and feeling heavier. They may become quite tender to touch.

Each breast will increase, on average, by 2in (5cm) and 3lb (1.4kg) during pregnancy. That is why it is important to wear the right bra, that fits you properly, even in the early stages of pregnancy.

Your nipples will also change: the areola (the darker skin around the nipple) may become darker in color and your nipples may tingle. As your breasts get bigger, you might notice blue veins appearing. All these breast changes are due to the hormone estrogen.

ASK A MIDWIFE

How can I ease the soreness in my breasts? Wearing a supportive bra can help with both the feelings of heaviness and soreness in your breasts, which are common in pregnancy. If your breasts are very tender at night, wearing a soft bra or bralette while you sleep may help. Try to avoid sleeping on your front if this causes discomfort. You may find that rubbing in a cream containing aloe vera is soothing.

ASK A NUTRITIONIST

I'm a bit of a coffee addict! Should I give it up now that I'm pregnant? The American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists advises that pregnant women should drink no more than 200 mg of caffeine per day. [Caffeine](#) is mostly found in coffee, tea, chocolate, and cola drinks.

If you drink a lot of coffee, then consider replacing it with decaffeinated varieties. There are various methods of decaffeination and, contrary to some popular belief, there is little evidence that the process of removing caffeine has a negative effect on health.

Many women can't stomach the smell and taste of coffee in pregnancy, and this can be one of the first signs you are pregnant. Even if you can tolerate it, consider replacing some of your cups